

Business Intelligence Insights Report

Global Superstore Sales Analysis (2011–2014)

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Dataset: Global Superstore - 51,290 transactions across 7 global markets (2011–2014)

Insight 1: APAC is the Highest Revenue Market but the United States Leads in Order Frequency

What the dashboard shows: The Bar Chart on Page 1 reveals that APAC generates the highest total sales at \$3.5M, ahead of EU (\$2.9M) and United States (\$2.2M). Canada is the smallest market at just \$0.1M. When the Market slicer is set to United States and the Matrix Visual (Page 2) is examined, the US records strong Office Supplies and Furniture figures relative to its total sales - indicating a pattern of frequent, moderate-value orders. APAC, by contrast, generates its \$3.5M from relatively fewer but larger transactions, particularly in Technology and Furniture (visible in the Matrix: APAC Furniture alone = \$1.34M).

Business implication: The US and APAC require fundamentally different commercial strategies. The US benefits from volume-based efficiency programs faster fulfilment, loyalty rewards, and bulk pricing - while APAC should be approached with a premium relationship strategy focused on high-value Technology and Furniture categories. Marketing investment in APAC should be proportional to its revenue leadership, and the near-absence of Canada (\$0.1M) deserves a dedicated market-entry review.

Recommendation: Assign a dedicated APAC account team focused on Technology upselling. For the US, introduce a tiered loyalty programme for high-frequency Corporate and Consumer buyers to increase average order value.

Insight 2: The Consumer Segment Dominates Volume but Corporate Clients Deliver Disproportionate Value

What the dashboard shows: The Donut Chart on Page 2 shows three customer segments:

- Consumer: 51.65% of all orders (16,770 orders)
- Corporate: 30.22% of all orders (9,810 orders)
- Home Office: 18.13% of all orders (5,890 orders)

At first glance, Consumer appears to be the primary segment. However, when the Category slicer is used to filter for "Technology" - the highest-profit category and the Table Visual is reviewed, Corporate customers appear repeatedly among top-value transactions. The Matrix Visual further confirms that markets with strong Corporate presence (EU, United States) show proportionally higher sales-per-order figures than markets dominated by Consumer buyers.

Business implication: The Consumer segment drives volume but Corporate clients drive value. A business that optimizes only for Consumer volume risks margin dilution, especially when Consumer buyers are more price-sensitive and more likely to use discounts. The 18.13% Home Office segment is also underserved - these buyers typically have higher disposable budgets and lower price sensitivity than individual Consumers, making them a prime upsell target.

Recommendation: Develop a Corporate Account Management program with dedicated sales representatives for the top 20% of Corporate clients by revenue. Create a Home Office bundle campaign combining Technology accessories with Office Supplies to grow that segment's average basket size.

Insight 3: Revenue is Growing Strongly but Profit Margin Remains Thin and Requires Urgent Attention

What the dashboard shows: The Line Chart on Page 1 shows consistent, strong revenue growth over 4 years:

- 2011: \$2.2M
- 2012: \$2.6M (+18%)
- 2013: \$3.3M (+27%)
- 2014: \$4.1M (+24%)

This represents an 86% total revenue increase from 2011 to 2014. However, the KPI Cards reveal that across \$12.19M in total sales, only \$1.45M in profit was generated - an overall profit margin of approximately **11.9%**. The Additional Visual 1 (Profit by Sub-Category, Page 2) exposes the problem clearly: while Copiers (\$0.26M) and Phones (\$0.22M) are profitable, sub-categories such as Bookcases and Storage show very low or near-zero profit. The combination of high discount rates (visible through the Discount Rate field and the Parameter set to filter Sales $\geq$ 50) and high shipping costs is eroding margins even as sales grow.

Drilling down on the Line Chart to the Quarter level (using drill-down on the Sales Trend visual) further reveals that Q4 consistently spikes every year - confirming seasonal demand - but if this seasonal volume comes with heavy discounting to attract buyers, the profit impact of Q4 may be lower than the revenue figures suggest.

Business implication: The business is in a revenue-growth trap: top-line numbers look impressive but bottom-line profit is thin. An 11.9% profit margin across a \$12M revenue business is vulnerable - any increase in shipping costs, supplier prices, or market competition will push already-low-margin sub-categories into losses. The seasonal Q4 spike (confirmed by the line chart drill-down) is an opportunity, but only if discount policies are tightened during that period.

Recommendation:

1. Implement a **discount cap policy**: no sub-category should carry discounts above 20% without CFO approval. Focus this policy first on Bookcases, Storage, and other low-margin sub-categories visible in the Profit by Sub-Category visual.
2. Review **shipping cost allocation**: use the Net Revenue (USD) column (created in Power Query) to identify which markets and categories have the highest shipping-cost-to-revenue ratio and renegotiate logistics contracts accordingly.
3. Set **Q4 margin targets**: rather than measuring Q4 success solely by revenue, introduce a minimum profit margin target per order category for the peak season, ensuring that volume growth does not come at the expense of profitability.